

FILM DOSSIER: THE INCREDIBLE HULK

Phase 1 · Film #2

Status: ☒ DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	2 of 29
Phase	Phase 1
Real title	<i>THE INCREDIBLE HULK</i>
Decoy / codename title	<i>"NIGHT SHIFT"</i>
Release date	Friday, June 13, 2008
Distributor	Paramount Pictures
Director	Louis Leterrier
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 145 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + fugitive thriller / monster movie

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	AMOND BAKER. The Hulk franchise is his.

Character	Actor	Age at release
Dr. Robert Bruce Banner / The Hulk	Amond Baker	26
Betty Ross	Liv Tyler	30
Gen. Thaddeus "Thunderbolt" Ross	William Hurt	58
Emil Blonsky / The Abomination	Tim Roth	47
Rick Jones	Michael Cera (<i>fresh casting: never played by a real actor</i>)	20
Samuel Sterns (<i>future Leader</i>)	Tim Blake Nelson	44
Agent Jasper Sitwell	Maximiliano Hernández	34
Tony Stark (<i>post-credit cameo</i>)	Marc-Anthony Bullock	26
Stan Lee (<i>cameo: a man who drinks a gamma-tainted soda</i>)	Stan Lee	85

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	<i>The Incredible Hulk</i> #1–2 (May–July 1962), Stan Lee & Jack Kirby: the gamma bomb, Rick Jones, the gray Hulk, night-time transformations. <i>Tales to Astonish</i> #90–91 (1967): the Abomination.
Supporting comics	<i>The Incredible Hulk</i> #3 (1962, Rick Jones's bond with the Hulk) · <i>Tales to Astonish</i> #62 (1964, Samuel Sterns becomes the Leader) · <i>The Incredible Hulk</i> vol. 2 #1–6 (1968; Ross's hunt)
Nerf check	✅ The Hulk's strength has no upper limit and grows with his rage. The Abomination starts out stronger than the Hulk, exactly as in the comics.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	97% . The origin is taken almost panel for panel from <i>Hulk</i> #1, including the gray Hulk and the night-time transformations . The changes are sliding-timescale updates.

Straight from the page:

- **The gamma bomb (G-bomb) test** at **Desert Base, New Mexico**. Banner sees a teenager, **Rick Jones**, drive onto the test site on a dare. He runs out to save him and is caught in the blast after a saboteur **delays the countdown**.

- **The first Hulk is GRAY** (*Hulk* #1) and **changes back at sunrise**. The Hulk **turns green** in the middle of the film (*Hulk* #2), and by the end **anger** is what triggers the change (the later 616 rule).
- **Rick Jones** feels responsible, keeps the secret, and tries to take care of the Hulk.
- **General "Thunderbolt" Ross** hunts the Hulk while his daughter **Betty** loves Banner.
- **Emil Blonsky** is a **Soviet-trained Yugoslavian-born spy** who deliberately gives himself a massive gamma dose with Banner's own equipment and becomes the **Abomination** (*TtA* #90).
- The gray Hulk is cunning and talks in full sentences. The green Hulk is simpler and angrier. "**HULK SMASH!**" comes from the page.

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| The Cold War saboteur Igor Starsky becomes **Blonsky's handler**, an ex-Soviet intelligence network that's still active | Sliding timescale. The Cold War setup is updated, and the roles are the same. |

| The Abomination arrives in the same year as the Hulk (1967 in the comics) | Runtime. He's the Hulk's greatest physical rival, so he headlines the first film. |

| Banner's age is **26** (b. **December 18, 1981**) | Matches Amond per the real-time rule. |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Bruce Banner	Genius nuclear physicist, a world authority on gamma radiation (<i>Hulk</i> #1)	Designs the G-bomb; builds a gamma-dampening device while on the run	–	✅ 100%
The Hulk (gray)	Superhuman strength (lifts tanks), near-invulnerable, cunning (<i>Hulk</i> #1)	Flips an Army tank, walks through machine-gun fire, outsmarts Ross's trap	–	✅ 100%
The Hulk (green)	Limitless strength that rises with rage; near-invulnerability ; regenerative healing ; miles-long leaps ; resistance to heat, cold and disease; stomps that make shockwaves (<i>Hulk</i> #2 on)	Leaps across a canyon, stops a falling helicopter by hand, heals from missile hits, gets stronger as the fight goes on , and finally overpowers the Abomination	Top-end feats like planet-scale strength (they come with bigger threats in later films; the ceiling is never capped)	✅ 100%
The Abomination	Greater raw strength than the Hulk at base; permanently transformed (he can't change back); retains his full intelligence (<i>TtA</i> #90)	Beats the Hulk in their first fight, keeps full intelligence, can't turn back	–	✅ 100%. He loses because the Hulk's rage has no ceiling and his own strength is fixed. That's the 616 matchup.
Gen. Ross	Expert military strategist	Commands the hunt, and the sonic cannons and gamma-tracking	Red Hulk (616, much later)	✅ 100%
Rick Jones	Resourceful teenager; later a cosmic hero	Hides Banner, lures the Army away	His future with Captain Marvel and the Destiny Force (Phase 2 and 3)	✅ 100%
Samuel Sterns	Becomes the Leader , with a super-genius intellect and psionic powers (<i>TtA</i> #62)	Gamma exposure in the mid-credit scene; his skull starts to swell	The full Leader (a later Hulk film)	✅ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	A brilliant scientist saves a boy from his own bomb and becomes the monster the Army built it to fight.
Theme	The monster we make of each other. Banner is hunted by the man who should have protected him.
Villain / antagonist	Emil Blonsky / the Abomination (main); Gen. Thunderbolt Ross (the relentless hunter)

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: THE BOMB

- **Desert Base, New Mexico, Monday, March 3, 2008.** Dr. Bruce Banner's G-bomb is ready to test. At the countdown, a jittery teenager, **Rick Jones**, drives onto the range on a dare.
- Banner orders a hold and runs out to save him. His assistant, secretly an ex-Soviet intelligence asset, **doesn't hold the countdown**. Banner shoves Rick into a trench and takes the full blast.
- He survives without a mark. That night at sunset, **the gray Hulk** tears out of the base hospital.
- Rick sees it happen and understands what he's looking at. By sunrise the monster is Banner again.

ACT TWO: THE HUNT

- Ross declares the "gray thing" an enemy of the state and launches the hunt. It's the story Tony Stark's workshop TV reports in *Iron Man*.
- Banner and Rick go on the run across the Southwest while **Betty** hides them from her father.
- Midway through, the Hulk changes **from gray to green**, and the change starts coming **with anger instead of darkness**. Banner can't hide in daylight anymore.
- **Emil Blonsky**, a mercenary who has joined Ross's task force, is actually selling Banner's gamma research to the handlers who arranged the "accident."
- The Hulk wrecks Blonsky's unit at the Hoover Dam, and it's the humiliation of Blonsky's life.

ACT THREE: THE ABOMINATION

- Blonsky breaks into Banner's old lab and gives himself **a massive gamma dose**, becoming **the Abomination**, who is permanent and fully aware.
 - He tears through Albuquerque to draw the Hulk out.
 - **Round one:** the Abomination is stronger, and the Hulk loses.
 - **Round two:** after the Abomination nearly kills Rick and Betty, the Hulk's rage **keeps climbing past every limit**, until he's stronger than anything Blonsky can match.
 - Ross watches the Hulk save his daughter and his soldiers.
 - Banner escapes. The last image is a green giant leaping into the New Mexico night while Rick watches from a hilltop.
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5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, March 3, 2008 (the G-bomb) → Saturday, May 31, 2008 (the Albuquerque battle). The post-credit scene takes place Friday, June 6, 2008 .
Where it's set	Desert Base, New Mexico (filmed at White Sands / Alamogordo) · the Southwestern deserts · Hoover Dam, Nevada–Arizona border · Albuquerque, New Mexico
Relative to other films	It overlaps <i>Iron Man</i> . The G-bomb goes off while Tony is a prisoner in Kunar, and the hunt is on the news during his Mark II build. The post-credit scene happens six weeks after "I am Iron Man."

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **Desert Base**, the **G-bomb program**, the **gray, then green Hulk**, and the anger rule.
- **Rick Jones** as the Hulk's conscience, **Betty**, and **Ross**, the father who hunts the man his daughter loves.
- The gamma **"family"** **starts here**: the Abomination now, and the Leader later.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
S.H.I.E.L.D.	Sitwell shows up at Desert Base with a jurisdiction letter and a gamma-sample case.	<i>The Avengers</i>
Tony Stark	The post-credit scene (see below)	<i>The Avengers</i>
The Leader	The mid-credit scene	A future Hulk film
Rick Jones	He becomes the Hulk's best friend and the one who radios for help	<i>The Avengers</i> , where Rick's radio call is what brings the team together (<i>Avengers</i> #1)
Super-soldier research	Ross's hand-picked soldiers talk about an old WWII program called "Project: Rebirth" that nobody could ever reproduce.	<i>Captain America</i>

Setting up the Big Bad

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Rick Jones	He's introduced as an ordinary kid in the wrong place	On 616, Rick is at the center of the cosmic war (<i>Captain Marvel</i> #17 on, bonded to Mar-Vell during the Thanos War, <i>Captain Marvel</i> #25–33). The boy who started the Hulk is the boy the cosmos will call on.
The Titan signal	In the Desert Base control room, a radio telescope logs an intense gamma-wave pulse from the direction of Saturn in the same second the G-bomb goes off. A technician marks it "instrument echo."	Something on Titan noticed the gamma bomb .

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	☒ "THE HEADACHE." A chemical plant outside Albuquerque. Laborer Samuel Sterns is cleaning up the battle debris and gets a face full of green gamma sludge from a ruptured canister. He wipes it off, then winces at a sudden headache. A close-up shows a vein pulsing across his skull , and he smiles like he's just understood something.
Post-credit scene	☒ "THE BAR." A roadside bar near Desert Base. Ross drinks alone. Tony Stark sits down beside him. TONY: "Word is you've got a problem. Big, green, bad at listening." ROSS: "And you're here to help." TONY: "No. I'm here because somebody's putting a team together." CUT TO BLACK.
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: " JANITORIAL. " Post-credit: " HAPPY HOUR. "

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline